OPERATIONS GUIDE

Brandix Kitchen

How meals are ordered, cooked, delivered, counted and billed — and what each person is responsible for at every step.

PREPARED FOR

The Brandix team

COVERS

Six delivery routes · three meals a day · the full order-to-billing cycle

STATUS

Live and in use

DATE

15 October 2026 · revision 2

1 · What this system does

It replaces the phone calls, WhatsApp messages and hand-made spreadsheets that used to sit between "how many people are eating tomorrow" and "how much food do we cook".

Every day the kitchen has to answer one question for each of six routes: how many plates, of what. Get it wrong one way and people go without; get it wrong the other and food is thrown away. Previously that answer travelled by message and was re-typed into a spreadsheet by hand.

Now there is one place where:

- each route enters what it needs, and can see that it was received;
- the kitchen sees every route's numbers in one list, and gets its production sheet calculated rather than typed;
- what was actually eaten is recorded against what was ordered;
- and the bill follows from what was eaten, not from what was guessed.

The six routes

Food is delivered along six routes. Each one books separately, for each meal.

ROUTE	TYPICAL HEADCOUNT	NOTES
Unit-1	150	
Unit-2	250	
Unit-3	250	
Unit-4	150	
Visakha	20	
Others	—	Optional; used when there is an extra requirement

> **THE RULE THAT SHAPES EVERYTHING**
>
> One route holds **one order per meal per day**. Tiffin, lunch and dinner are three separate bookings. The system will not let the same route be booked twice for the same meal on the same day.

2 · Who does what

Four kinds of account. Each sees only the screens for their job.

ROLE	WHAT THEY DO	WHAT THEY CAN SEE
Booking	Enters how many plates a route needs, and afterwards records what was actually consumed and how the food was.	Only their own orders. Not other routes', not other people's.
Kitchen	Sets the menu. Watches orders arrive. Downloads the packing sheet. Marks each order as preparing, dispatched, delivered.	Every route's orders for a given day.
Verification	Checks the consumption figures a route submits, and either approves them or sends them back with a reason. Approving fixes the amount payable.	The queue of figures waiting to be checked, and the payment history.
Super Admin	Manages accounts, routes, dishes, rates and settings. Can also book on a route's behalf when that route's own booker is away.	Everything.

WHY A BOOKER SEES ONLY THEIR OWN

A route's consumption figures decide what that route is billed. Letting one booker edit another's would put the bill in the wrong hands. So a booker can open, correct and close out their own meals and nobody else's — and when an admin books on a route's behalf, the order is labelled with their name so the kitchen can see at a glance that the route's usual booker never touched it.

3 · The daily cycle

The same loop runs for every meal: book → cook → deliver → count → check → comment → book again.

1. ROUTE

   Enter the plate counts

   Turn on the meal and enter three numbers — plates of Item 1, Item 2 and Item 3. No dishes to pick: the kitchen's menu already says what those three items are that day.

2. KITCHEN

   Watch the day fill up

   Orders appear as they arrive, with a running count of how many of the six routes have booked.

3. KITCHEN

   Download the packing sheet

   Once all six routes are in, the sheet is generated: quantities per dish per route, and the cans to fill. Nothing is typed by hand.

4. KITCHEN

   Cook, pack, dispatch

   The order is marked *preparing*, then *dispatched*, then *delivered*. The route can see where its meal has got to.

5. ROUTE

   Record what was actually eaten

   After the meal, enter the plates actually consumed against each item. Leftovers are worked out automatically.

6. VERIFICATION

   Check the figures

   Approve them, or send them back with a reason. A returned close-out reopens with the previous numbers still filled in, so only the wrong one needs changing.

7. ROUTE

   Say how the food was

   Rate taste and quality, and note anything wrong. This opens only after the figures are approved.

8. SYSTEM

   The meal closes, and the route can book again

   Feedback is what closes the loop. Until it is given, that route cannot book the same meal again.

> **WHY THE LOOP IS ENFORCED**
>
> If a route could keep ordering without ever saying what it ate, nobody would ever know how much food was wasted, and there would be no reliable basis for the bill. Holding the next order until the last one is closed out is what keeps the consumption record complete.

4 · Booking: the three numbers

Bookers do not choose dishes. The kitchen decides what is cooked; the route decides how much.

For tiffin and dinner, each day's menu has three items. The booking screen shows what they are for that day, what comes with each, and a box for the number of plates:

ITEM	THAT DAY'S DISH	SERVED WITH	PLATES
Item 1	Idly — 4 pieces a plate	Sambar 60 g, FG Chutney 80 g	150
Item 2	Biryani — 300 g a plate	Kurma 120 g	450
Item 3	Wada — 4 pieces a plate	Sambar 60 g, FG Chutney 80 g	150

The accompaniments are never ordered separately. Sambar is cooked for every plate of Item 1 *and* every plate of Item 3 — in the example above, for 300 plates, not 150.

Changing an order after placing it

A mistyped plate count can be corrected. A **Change** button sits on the booking in My Bookings while it is still safe to use it — that is, while the ordering window is open, the kitchen has not started the meal, and no close-out has begun. Once the kitchen begins, the button disappears and the correction has to go through them. Only the quantities change: a different route, day or meal is a new booking.

Lunch is different

Lunch is a full thali of eight or so dishes, so it is booked as a **headcount** — one number, how many people are eating. The screen shows that day's thali so the route knows what is coming.

Repeating yesterday

Most routes order roughly the same amount each day. A one-tap option refills the three numbers from that route's last order of the same meal, which can then be adjusted.

5 · When you can book

MEAL	WHEN IT IS ORDERED	DEADLINE
Morning Tiffin	Today, for tomorrow	Any time during the day before
Dinner	Today, for tomorrow	Any time during the day before
Lunch	Same day	**Before 11:00 AM**
Emergency	Same day, any meal	Any time — see section 9

Tiffin and dinner can only be booked for *tomorrow* — not for today, and not for the day after. This is deliberate: the kitchen buys and preps on the strength of the previous evening's numbers, so an order placed for three days out would be a number nobody is acting on.

> **ALL TIMES ARE INDIA TIME**
>
> The lunch deadline is India time regardless of where the person booking happens to be. It is a setting, not a fixed rule — the kitchen can move it, and the booking screen always shows the time actually in force.

6 · The menu

The kitchen owns the menu. Routes only choose quantities.

There are two ways the kitchen changes what is cooked, kept deliberately separate:

WHAT IS BEING CHANGED	EFFECT	USED FOR
The weekly plan	Changes **every** Tuesday (or whichever day) from now on.	A standing change to what the kitchen cooks.
One day	Changes **that one date only**. The weekly plan is untouched.	A festival, a delivery that did not arrive, a visitor.

Tiffin and dinner run on a one-week cycle — the same Monday menu every Monday. Lunch runs on a **fortnight**: there is a week 1 Monday thali and a week 2 Monday thali, alternating.

> **A MENU CANNOT BE CHANGED AFTER ROUTES HAVE BOOKED**
>
> Once any route has booked a meal, that day's menu is locked. An order records what was ordered at the moment it was placed, so changing the menu afterwards would not change what those routes asked for — it would only make the records disagree. The screen greys out the edit and says how many routes have booked.

7 · From plate counts to cans of food

The packing sheet is calculated from the orders. It is the same sheet the kitchen already used — the arithmetic is now done for it.

A worked example

Unit-1 books a Tuesday tiffin: 150 plates of Item 1, 450 of Item 2, 150 of Item 3.

DISH	PLATES	PER PLATE	TO COOK	IN CANS OF	CANS
Idly	150	4 pcs	600 pcs	200 pieces	3
Biryani	450	300 g	135 kg	20 kg	6.75
Wada	150	4 pcs	600 pcs	200 pieces	3
Sambar (with items 1 & 3)	300	60 g	18 kg	15 kg	1.2
FG Chutney (with items 1 & 3)	300	80 g	24 kg	15 kg	1.6
Kurma (with item 2)	450	120 g	54 kg	15 kg	3.6
Total ordered	**750**				

Note that the total is **750** — the plates the route asked for. Accompaniments are cooked but not counted into the total, because nobody ordered them.

How cans are filled

- **Counted items** (idly, wada, bhonda) go into cans of 200, 160, 120, 80 or 40 pieces. The sheet fills the largest cans first, then rounds the remainder up to the smallest can that will hold it.
- **Weight items** (rice, sambar, gravies) go into 15 kg or 20 kg cans depending on the dish, shown to two decimals — 6.75 cans, not "about 7".

The slip that travels with the food

Alongside the kitchen's sheet there is a **delivery note per route**: one page listing only what that route is receiving, dish by dish, with the cans spelled out, a box to tick as each is loaded, and lines for the person packing and the person receiving to sign.

When the sheet is ready

The sheet is complete once all six routes have booked. The kitchen can pull it earlier if it needs to — it then prints with **PARTIAL — 4 of 6 routes booked** across the top, and names which routes are still missing, so nobody cooks from a short sheet without knowing it.

8 · After the meal — and what it costs

Three steps, in this order. Each one opens only when the one before it is done.

1 ROUTE

Consumption

Enter the plates actually consumed against each item. Leftover is calculated for you. If more was served than ordered, that is fine — enter the real number. You can add a note for the kitchen.

2 VERIFICATION

The check

The team compares consumed against ordered and either approves or returns the figures. A return **must** carry a reason, so the route knows what to correct.

3 ROUTE

Feedback

Rate taste and quality out of five and note anything wrong — "sambar arrived cold", "idly short by 20". A low score or any written remark reaches the kitchen the same day rather than at month end.

What is billed

Charged on	Plates **consumed** — not plates ordered.
Rate	A rate per plate, set per dish where a dish needs its own, otherwise a single standard rate.
Accompaniments	Never charged separately — they are part of the plate.
Fixed when	At the moment verification approves. Changing a rate later does not move an already-approved bill.

WHY THE AMOUNT IS FROZEN AT APPROVAL

If the bill were recalculated every time it was looked at, a rate change made in November would silently alter September's invoices. Freezing the amount when the figures are approved means a past month stays as it was agreed.

9 · When things do not go to plan

Something came up after the deadline

An **emergency order** can be placed at any time, for any meal, as a headcount. It is exempt from the ordering deadlines and from the close-out rule, because it exists for exactly the day when something has gone wrong, and it does not itself block the next normal order.

It does need an administrator to agree to it. Until they do, the kitchen does not see it and it is not counted in the packing sheet — nothing is cooked on the strength of a request nobody has approved. The decision arrives as a notification. If it is declined, the reason comes with it, and the route is not then chased to close out a meal that never happened.

Verification sent our figures back

The meal reopens at the consumption step with the previous numbers already filled in and the reason shown at the top. Correct what is wrong and send it again. It does not go to the back of a queue.

Our booker is away

A Super Admin can book on the route's behalf. They must name the route — it is a deliberate act, not an automatic one — and the order then shows as *placed by [name] (admin)* in the bookings list and on the kitchen's screen. The admin is also the one who closes it out afterwards.

We forgot to close out and now cannot book

That is the system working as intended. Open **Close a Meal**; it will show exactly which step is outstanding — enter consumption, wait for verification, or give feedback. Finish it and the next booking opens immediately.

A route has not booked and it is nearly cooking time

The kitchen's screen shows which routes are still missing by name. The packing sheet can be pulled anyway, marked PARTIAL.

10 · Using it day to day

On a phone

The system is designed for a phone first — the people booking are rarely at a desk. Opening it in the phone's browser offers an **Add to home screen** option; it then opens full-screen with its own icon, like any other app. There is nothing to install from an app store.

Signing in

Each person has their own account. Accounts are created by the Super Admin, except for booking accounts, which can be requested from the sign-in screen and approved.

Notifications

The bell icon carries the things that need attention: a meal delivered and awaiting its close-out, figures returned by verification with a reason, a close-out waiting to be checked, or feedback the kitchen should see.

Can we see what the other routes ordered?

No. A booker sees their own route's orders only. The kitchen and the admin see everything.

Can we change an order after placing it?

Not at present — see section 11. Today the way to correct one is to ask the kitchen or an admin.

What if we enter the wrong consumption figure?

Verification will return it with a reason, and it reopens with your numbers still in place for correcting.

Does the food quantity depend on what we book?

Entirely. The kitchen cooks to the plate counts entered. That is why the deadlines matter.

11 · Where it stands today

The full cycle described in this document is live and in daily use. These are the things that are not yet finished, stated plainly.

AREA	STATUS
Booking by three plate counts	LIVE
Changing an order after placing it	LIVE
Menu managed by the kitchen	LIVE
Adjustable lunch deadline	LIVE
Packing sheet & can calculations	LIVE
Per-route delivery notes	LIVE
Emergency orders approved by an admin	LIVE
Consumption → verification → feedback	LIVE
Billing from consumed plates	LIVE
Works as a phone app	LIVE

Outstanding

ITEM	WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICE
The standard rate per plate	A commercial figure, so it is entered rather than assumed. Until it is set, approved close-outs show no amount. One field under Settings.
Cancelling an order outright	Quantities can be changed, but a booking cannot be withdrawn altogether — the kitchen has to do that. Worth adding if it comes up in practice.

CHANGED SINCE THE FIRST DRAFT OF THIS GUIDE

Four things this document previously listed as unfinished are now done: changing an order after placing it, the adjustable lunch deadline, approval of emergency orders, and the per-route delivery note. Three dishes that showed one quantity on screen while the kitchen cooked another — Sambar, FG Chutney and Kurma — now show the cooked figure, so a route is told what actually arrives.